efforts to maintain peace, but also similar congratulatory letters and telegrams from heads of state of third-world countries, especially leaders of the nonaligned movement such as Premier Jawaharlal Nehru of India.

Not all of that was pure propaganda. Many around the world were indeed grateful to Khrushchev for backing away from the brink of nuclear war, and some saw the outcome of the crisis as an American defeat. On October 28, the day the world media reported on Khrushchev's acceptance of Kennedy's offer, the Brazilian ambassador Roberto de Oliveira Campos reported from Washington that because Cuba was being recognized as a country that had defended itself, "the moral posture of the United States suffered strain and that, in spite of having originated the crisis, Khrushchev appears in the eyes of neutralist world opinion as a peace-maker."[16]

But outside the Soviet-controlled and nonaligned world, Khrushchev was perceived more as a loser than as a winner. In the United States, Kennedy was judged the victor. "Russian Accedes: Tells President Work on Bases Is Halted—Invites Talks," ran the title of a *New York Times* article published on October 29. Oliveira Campos sensed the atmosphere of jubilation among American officials. "In Washington it is considered that the incident 1) demonstrates the truth of the North American accusation of the existence of nuclear arms; 2) the judgment of the Pentagon to be correct that at this moment the Russians recognize North American nuclear superiority; 3) that after an extreme cost of efforts in the last four months, with expenses estimated at a million dollars per day, the Soviets have returned to the point of departure, extracting from the United States only a guarantee of non-invasion, a declaration that Washington had already made unilaterally."[17]

The same feeling was also spreading in Western Europe. The *New York Times* Moscow correspondent, Seymour Topping, based his assessment of the outcome on the opinions of Western diplomats and reporters in Moscow. They saw the "abrupt manner in which the proposal about Turkey was dropped after it had been rejected by President Kennedy as humiliating for Moscow." "Western observers here believe that Mr. Khrushchev's letter represents a retreat on the Cuban issues that may have profound reverberations," continued Topping. "The manner in which this question has been handled, from the clandestine installation of the missile bases to